



Parish of Downpatrick

Sunday 13 September 2026

24th, Sunday in Ordinary Time



PRIESTS: Fr Eugene O'Neill PP, Fr. Jim Conway CC

Contacts:

Parish Office: 07337 485743 (TEMPORARY PARISH OFFICE NUMBER)

For emergencies please ring (for example- an urgent sick call or a sudden death): 07841101678

Temporary Address until further notice: Patrician Youth Centre, John Street, BT30 6HS

New Office hours 10.00am – 2.00pm Monday & Thursday
New office hours 10.00am – 1.00pm Tuesday & Wednesday

Parish Support Officer: Tel: 07337 485743

You can contact us by telephone or email. Since Downpatrick is a very busy Parish Office; we can't always answer the phone immediately. Please leave a message with your telephone number and we will call you back.

Parish email: downpatrick@downandconnor.org

Website: www.stpatricksdowndpatrick.com



Priests on Retreat: beginning on the evening of Sunday 13 September, the priests of the diocese will be gathering together with Bishop Alan in Drumantine for three days of prayer. The Bishop has given permission for all Masses to be cancelled on those days. However, due to the kindness of Canon Murray, all our Masses in Downpatrick will **continue as normal**. Deacon Jackie Breen has graciously undertaken to look after funerals. We are grateful to them both. Please pray for your priests as we will be praying for you. Fr Eugene

Mass Schedule:

Downpatrick Parish Mass Schedule:

Weekend Masses

Vigils

St. Patrick's 5pm

St Brigid's 6.30pm

Sunday

St Patrick's 10.30am

St. Malachy's – 1st Sunday of the Month – 9am –

Daily Masses

Monday 7.30pm **St. Patrick's**

Tues – Friday 10am **St. Patrick's**

St. Colmcille's

Wednesday 7:30pm

Sacrament of Baptism: 2nd, 3rd & 4th Sunday of each month

Confession available in St Patrick's, Saturdays 4.15pm – 4.45pm

PARISH COLLECTIONS:

06 September 2026

Offertory £2494 Monthly: £2025

To donate directly via Bank Transfer the parish bank details are: **Account Name: Parish of Downpatrick, Account Number: 80146471, Sort Code: 95-06-79** (please add an identifying name to your transaction) please contact your bank to arrange.

Dona Card Machine is available for convenience at Our Lady's Shrine.

Thank You for your ongoing support.

NAME CHANGE

You will have noticed that the new title "PARISH SUPPORT OFFICER" is being used in the bulletin information section and in the job advertisements in this weeks parish bulletin. This is simply the new term for parish secretary being used across the diocese.

MASS INTENTIONS:

Saturday 12 September, St. Patrick's, 5pm:

Month's Mind: Anthony Sturgess,

1st Anniv: Maudie Marks, John McCormick, Christopher Scallan,

Anniv: Mark McKee, Jackie Walsh, Josephine Torney, Michael Scallan,

Saturday 12 September, St. Brigid's, 6:30pm:

Month's Mind: Michael Millar,

Sunday 13 September, St. Patrick's, 10:30am:

Month's Mind: Dermot MacNabb,

Anniv: Rosaleen MacNabb,

Monday 14 September, St. Patrick's, 7:30pm:

Month's Mind: Padraig Jeffers,

Anniv: Margaret Tracey, Fiona Turley, Josephine Torney.

Saturday 19 September, St. Patrick's, 5pm:

Month's Mind: Briege Quail,

Monday 21 September, St. Patrick's, 7:30pm:

1st Anniv: Alfie Williamson, **Anniv:** Patricia McCashin,

If you would like a Mass booking, please drop into the sacristy and make the booking directly with the priest.

Your Prayers are Requested for:

Recently Deceased: Elizabeth Magorrian, David McClean, Jackie Kelly (London),

Anniv: John Mullan, Tommy & Elizabeth (Lily) Hogan, Patrick & Margaret Hanna, Elizabeth Stitt, Freddie Stitt, Thomas Kelly, Vera Marron, Pat McDonald, Irene Cochrane, Bertha Cleland, Mary Quinn,

Lectio Divina has resumed from Tuesday 8th September at 11 o'clock. We will be using the small room in the church that is used on Sundays for children's liturgy. Lectio Divina is the practice of reading scripture, meditation and prayer. New members are very welcome.

Legion of Mary Annual Trip to Knock will take place on Sunday 27th September. The cost is £30 per person, making the usual stops for breaks. Pick up points are at the following Churches:- Newcastle – (back of the Church) 6.15am, Castlewellan – 6.30am, Downpatrick – 6.45am, Crossgar – 7am and Saintfield – 7.15am. To book your place you can place your money in an envelope along with your name and phone number and drop it into the Parish offices in Saul or Downpatrick (Patrician Youth Centre) or you can phone Geraldine on 07845 422723

RCIA 2026 / 2027: Thinking about becoming Catholic or want to deepen your understanding of the faith? The Diocesan RCIA (Rite of Christian Initiation of Adults) is a journey of faith, formation, and community for adults who wish to explore the teachings of Jesus Christ and the Catholic Church. It is open to anyone unbaptised, those baptised in another Christian tradition, or Catholics wishing to reconnect with their faith. The 2026–2027 programme begins on Wednesday 23 September and runs weekly from 6.30 to 8.00 pm at St Mary's Hall, Chapel Lane, Belfast. Sessions include prayer, teaching, discussion, and time for questions. Spouses, fiancés or friends are also very welcome to attend alongside participants. All are welcome, whether you are exploring faith for the first time or returning after some time away. To find out more, scan the QR code or visit our information page, or email rcia@downandconnor.org to register.





TOBAR MHUIRE RETREAT
A Sacred Space in the Heart of Co. Down



JAMES KEELAGHAN
IN CONCERT

James Keelaghan has been called "Canada's finest songwriter." He has traversed the world singing his songs that are soulfully stepped in history. Keelaghan lives for history and entices the listener with his detailed entertaining monologues and songs about real-life people whose lives represent the universal human condition.

Sunday 27th September 2026
Doors open 7pm for 7.30 pm Concert
Donation £20

FUND RAISING CONCERT SUPPORTING TOBAR MHUIRE

DIOCESE OF DOWN AND CONNOR Parish of Dunloy and Cloughmills

Are seeking to recruit a part-time Caretaker. The role will be based at Bridge Road Dunloy. Availability to work flexible hours is required including evenings and weekends. Rate of Pay £12.71

Full details on www.downandconnor.org or Community NI website as well as Church posters. **Closing date 12 noon Monday 28th September**

Down and Connor Diocesan Trust is an Equal Opportunities Employer

ST OLCAN'S PRIMARY SCHOOL, ARMOY Temporary Building Supervisor

Required - require a temporary cleaner for 18.5 hours per week with immediate start, initially for 1 month but may be extended, experience preferred. Please send your CV to mkennedy502@c2kni.net if you would be interested in this post.

TRÓCAIRE Could You Help Share the True Spirit of Christmas? Each year, volunteers in parishes across the north of Ireland set up a small stall after Masses to sell Trócaire's Gifts of Change — meaningful gifts that make a real difference to families living in poverty around the world. We provide everything you need including training and support. All we ask is a little time and a big heart. Last Christmas, 50 parishes took part — and we'd love to grow that number even more this year! If you would like to find out more about how you can help, please email Mark at mark.mcmahon@trocaire.org or call 028 9080 8030.

QUEEN'S CATHOLIC CHAPLAINCY – WE'RE BACK!

The Catholic Chaplaincy at Queen's reopens for the new academic year on Monday 14 September, with weekday Masses and our semester programme resuming. Our first Sunday Mass is 20 September at the new, earlier time of 7.00pm. Please note the new time!

New or returning student? Find out about what's on, ways to connect and get involved, and student accommodation at Ryan Hall at qubcatholic.org and on our socials. Staff and alumni are always welcome too. Visit our newly renewed Chaplaincy at 28 Elmwood Avenue for Mass, Confessions or candle lighting — and call into Mosaic for some of the best coffee, hot lunches and home-baked treats in South Belfast!

VINTED & MORE NIGHT Come along & grab a bargain!! Friday 23rd Oct 2026 From 5pm-8pm Cloughmills Community Hall A night filled with selling & buying preloved clothing & local vendors selling their goods!! Free admission / Everyone welcome!! See Vinted & More on Facebook!!

SVP.Helpline 07349983363

Bulletin notices by 12 noon Thursdays



Twenty Fourth Sunday in Ordinary Time
13 September 2026

Very Rev. Canon Colm McBride PP :

Parochial House 44 Lough Road Loughguile BT44 9JN

Tel: 028 276 41206

Email: loughguile@downandconnor.org

Facebook: St Patrick's and St MacNissi's

Parish Office Hours Mon Wed Thurs 10 a.m.- 2.30 p.m.

Tues 10-4.30. p.m.

***PARISH MASS NOTICE -THIS INCOMING WEEK THERE WILL BE NO
PARISH MASS ON MONDAY , TUESDAY OR WEDNESDAY***

We are called to forgive; and that can be really difficult.

You have been defrauded by the banks of your life's savings - can you forgive?

You were abused as a child - can you forgive?

You were done out of a job because another lied to get it - can you forgive?

The answer is maybe 'no'.

What then does God want?

He asks us to open our hearts to the other so that we may forgive. Forgiveness is the deepest of God's desires on our behalf, and he hopes that we can forgive each other.

Our hurts and burdens are heavy to carry through life. To forgive can release some of that weight. The person who hurt us may be dead, or may not even know (or care) that we are hurting. When we desire to forgive but don't know how, one way of looking for this strength is to pray for it. We often pray, 'Lord, make my heart like yours'. When we pray that we are praying to be forgiving people!

Another way is to pray for the person. When we realise that as God loves me, he also loves everyone, we may find a spark or light of forgiveness in our souls. Out of this we may find the will to meet the other and talk to him or her, and find the grace of forgiveness between us. Forgiveness sometimes comes slowly. When God sees us wanting to be on the road to forgiveness, he gives us the graces we need to unburden ourselves and be able to love like him.

Sit in silence for a while, and send a blessing or prayer to someone you need to forgive.

Lord, I ask - make my heart like yours. (CatholicIreland.net)

PARKING AT ST PATRICK'S CHURCH

Last week a young child on a bicycle was almost knocked down as she attempted to cross the Coolkeeran Road outside the Church.

She had correctly chosen the spot where the Kerb is lowered to accommodate pedestrians moving to and from the Church Car park.

However, vehicles had been parked on the road outside the Church gate and she wasn't immediately seen by the driver of the oncoming vehicle. Fortunately she wasn't physically hurt.

As parishioners will be aware, the Coolkeeran Road is an arterial road within the parish, the Coolkeeran / Lough Road junction is one of the busiest within our parish.

It is imperative that parishioners take action now ,change practice and park at all times in the Church car park and not on the road outside the Church gate.

HLI IRELAND: Fr Lawrence Carney (USA), international speaker and popular author, Provincial Tour of Ireland. Join us for the Ulster event at the Canal Court Hotel, Newry, on Tuesday 29th September at 6:45pm, with a First Class Relic of St Thérèse. Free admission.

CATHOLIC MEN'S RETREAT - STANDING IN THE BREACH A Catholic Men's Retreat will take place at Portglenone Monastery on Saturday 19 September 2026, from 9am to 1pm. The theme of the retreat is "It is no longer I who live, but Christ who lives in me" (Galatians 2:20). The morning will include prayer, teaching, fellowship and men's testimonies, with Fr Eddie McGee as keynote speaker. All men are very welcome. For further information, contact Thomas Carey on 07967 620435 or email sean@catholicminute.co.uk.

BEGINNING EXPERIENCE The loss of a partner through death, separation or divorce is devastating. Beginning Experience is offering a programme of bereavement support in St Bride's Hall, Derryvolgie Ave., Belfast on three Saturdays (26th September 24th October and 21st November) Booking essential. To find out more contact Marie 07896119669 or email belfastbe@yahoo.com

THE LEGION OF MARY ANNUAL PILGRIMAGE to Knock Shrine will take place on Sunday 27 September 2026. A coach will leave Dunloy Parish Centre at 7am, returning by 9.30pm. Information/booking: 07471 537 051

ALZHEIMER'S SOCIETY MEMORY WALK is back for 2026! Take part in Memory Walk this autumn and walk to fund faster diagnosis and vital support.. Belfast Ormeau Pk on Sat **26 Sept** Sign up todaymemorywalk.org.uk 0300 330 5452

Saturday 12 th Sept	7.30 p.m.	St Patrick's	Ministers of the Word Shane McMahon	Ministers of the Eucharist A. McNaughton & M. McMullan <i>Anniversary Mass Rosemarie Laverty</i>
Sunday 13 th Sept	9.30 a.m.	St MacNissi's	Pat McAuley	Joseph McCarry & M. Young <i>Anniversary Mass Ann McFadden</i>
	11.30 a.m.	St Patrick's	Orlagh McArthur	C. Casey & G. McMillan
Monday 14 th Sept	7.30 p.m.	St MacNissi's	NO PARISH MASS TODAY	
Tuesday 15 th Sept	9.30 a.m.	St MacNissi's	NO PARISH MASS TODAY	
Wed 16 th Sept	7.30 p.m.	St Patrick's	NO PARISH MASS TODAY	
Thursday	9.30 a.m.	St Patrick's	Mass followed by Adoration 10.00 a.m. -12 noon.	
Friday	9.30 a.m.	St Patrick's	Mass	
Saturday 19 th Sept	7.30 p.m.	St Patrick's	Ministers of the Word Damian McCloskey	Ministers of the Eucharist M. McCloskey & T. Devlin <i>Anniversary Mass John Reid</i>
Sunday 20 th Sept	9.30 a.m.	St MacNissi's	Majella Murray	V.McDonnell & M.McKinley
	11.30 a.m.	St Patrick's	Paula Casey	T.McIntyre & B. Connolly

ANNIVERSARIES Bridie Carey Annie Douthart Anna Greene
Patrick and Ellen Hetherington Rosemarie Laverty Harry McAuley
Eilish McClements John McCloskey Ann McFadden Tilly McGill
Tom O'Neill Annemarie Rafferty John Reid Joe Robinson John Waide

BAPTISMS The Sacrament of Baptism will be celebrated on the **1st and 3rd Sunday** of the month **only** after the 11.30 a.m. Mass. To book please contact the Parish Office. A copy of the child's long birth certificate is required within a week of booking. On the day please bring a Baptism Candle and a white Shawl.

ANNIVERSARY/MONTH MIND MASS Please now book through the office, these can be booked for any scheduled Mass **excluding Sunday 11.30 a.m.**

WEDDING BOOKING Please ring the office for initial bookings.

WEEKLY COLLECTION £1415.00 Thank you for your support.
Autumn Offering will be taken up **next** weekend.

DAY TRIP TO KNOCK: Saturday 3rd October. Bus leaving St Patrick's Church Loughguile at 6am. Contact Patricia Campbell on 02827641120 or 07871626940. Price approx. £30 depending on numbers.



PARISH OF ST TERESA OF ÁVILA

Web Page: www.stteresasparish.church

Email: stteresas@downandconnor.org

Black Mountain Family of Parishes

Fr Gabriel Lyons 028 9061 2855 g.lyons@downandconnor.org

Parish Office Open Tuesday, Wednesday and Thursday 9am to 3pm.

13 September 2026, Twenty Fourth Sunday of Ordinary Time, Year A .

Sunday Gospel *The story of the unforgiving servant is a lesson in what faithful forgiveness means. At the heart of forgiveness there is a grace. Grace is something that cannot be contained or controlled. Grace shows us that where there is real mercy and forgiveness, there is sharing and generosity. Put simply it means that if you fully receive the mercy of God, it will compel you to share it, to be kind and merciful to your neighbour. It is a difficult notion to understand in a world, or economy, where we are encouraged to be selfish and greedy and make sure that, 'nobody will make a fool out of me'. Time to get real about faith: if you seek and accept God's forgiveness its fruit is the forgiveness you will share with others. (Fr S Crumpton).*

Sunday Masses Church of the Holy Spirit (Sat.) Vigil **5pm**, St Matthias' **10am**, St Teresa's **12noon**.

Weekday Masses St Teresa's, Tuesday, Wednesday, Thursday & Friday **10am**.

St Matthias Monday **7pm**, Wednesday **9am**, Friday **7am** & Saturday **10am**.

Confessions Saturday **4 30pm** in Church of the Holy Spirit, after any Mass and on request.

Adoration of the Blessed Sacrament every Wednesday in St Matthias' Church from 11am to 4pm.

Black Mountain Family of Parishes, **Season of Creation Celebration** in St Teresa's Church Thursday, 1 October 2026 at 7pm. All are welcome to attend.

To book an Anniversary Mass, Baptism or Wedding Ceremony please email the Parish Office.

Recently Deceased: Pauline McKenna, Bernie Robinson.

Months Mind: Ann Montgomery.

Anniversaries: Gerard McCann, Gerard Glennon, Harry Holland, Jack McIlroy, John McIlroy, Jimmy and Nan Moore.

Weekly Collection: £1 226. **Monthly Collection:** £1 989. *Thank you for your continued support.*

The loss of a partner through death, separation or divorce is devastating. **Beginning Experience** is offering a programme of bereavement support in St Bride's Hall, Derryvolgie Ave., Belfast on three Saturdays (26 September, 24 October and 21 November 2026) Booking essential. To find out more contact Marie 07896119669 or email belfastbe@yahoo.com